# GOLF MAGAZINE

2026–2027



*Where golf meets paradise*

# COSTA RICA

5 TOURNAMENTS · 15 COURSES · 6 RESORTS

BY TRAVEL XM

*The 2026–2027 season*

# TOURNAMENTS



**21**
NOV 2026

## CRGAR GOLF TOURNAMENT — GUANACASTE

*Hacienda Pinilla Golf Club*

The Costa Rica Guanacaste Association of Realtors brings back its tournament after a ten-year break. Full details still to be announced.

**4-6**
DEC 2026

## CAMPEONATO METROPOLITANO — SAN JOSÉ

*Costa Rica Country Club · Los Reyes · Cariari*

Handicap divisions plus senior, women's and junior categories, with WAGR points in designated divisions. General entry US$250; association members usually pay less.

**13**
DEC 2026

## THE HOWLER OPEN — NEAR COCO, GUANACASTE

*Tres Volcanes Golf & Country Club*

An 18-hole charity tournament supporting International Animal Rescue Costa Rica, open to golfers, sponsors and supporters.

**13**
FEB 2027

## LA IGUANA INVITATIONAL — PLAYA HERRADURA

*La Iguana Golf Course · Los Sueños Marriott*

The 24th edition: a daytime shotgun start, then a night-golf round for the top 75. Teams of three; US$325 + tax per person (US$367.25).

**14-18**
MAY 2027

## GUANATICO OPEN — GUANACASTE

*Reserva Conchal (May 14) · Tres Volcanes (15) · Hacienda Pinilla (18)*

A multi-course event for visiting and local golfers, with a published itinerary, social events and optional accommodation packages.

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The Costa Rican Golf Federation publishes an events calendar; 2027 listings weren't out at press time.

*We'll book your spot*

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*Where to play, when to compete, what to pack and where to stay.*






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*I · History*

# A CENTURY OF GOLF



## 1902

San José's Golf Club opens on January 19 in La Sabana. Over time the club shifted toward other sports, including tennis.

## 1940s

The Costa Rica Country Club opens a nine-hole course, the country's main golf facility for decades. Membership was selective, and golf stayed tied to wealthier residents.

## 1973

Cariari Country Club opens with an 18-hole course by George Fazio. It hosted PGA Tour-sponsored events in 1979 and 1980.

## 1990s

Tourism takes golf beyond private clubs. New courses appear on the Pacific coast, including today's Reserva Conchal, originally Garra de León.

## 2000s

Golf joins luxury tourism, with courses built into resorts and residential developments in Guanacaste and the Central Pacific.



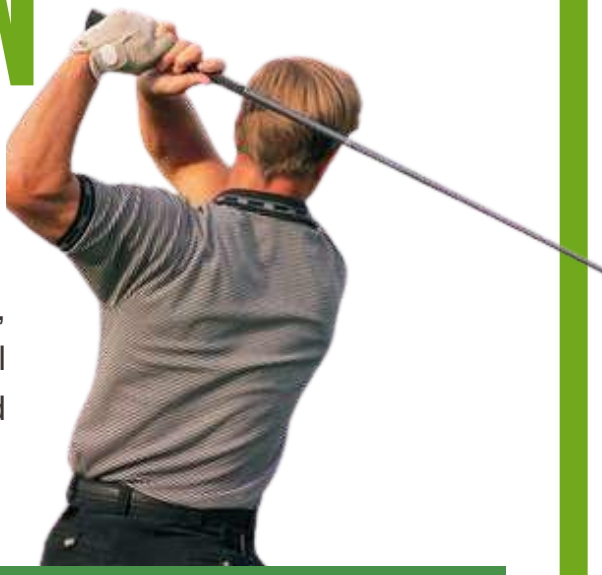
## Today

Private clubs, public courses and resort golf. The Central Valley remains an established golfing area; Guanacaste and the Central Pacific draw international visitors.

# Where golf meets paradise



# WHO PLAYS GOLF IN COSTA RICA



A mix of international visitors, expats, local club members, business professionals and competitive amateurs. Coastal resort courses serve a different crowd from the established private clubs of the GAM.

## 01
### *International visitors*
**Mostly from the US and Canada, some from Europe. They come to play, or add rounds to a trip of beaches, wildlife and luxury stays — mainly in Guanacaste and the Central Pacific, where access is easier.**

## 02
### *Expats and residents*
**Part of the regular golfing community, especially in the Central Valley, where established clubs offer recurring play, social events and local tournaments.**



## 03
### *Local professionals*
**Business people, entrepreneurs, club members and weekend players. Cariari and Costa Rica Country Club carry long traditions; Valle del Sol and Los Reyes welcome locals and visitors.**

## 04
### *Amateurs and juniors*
**An organised competitive scene with amateur tournaments, national championships and junior development. The national federation runs handicaps and publishes calendars.**



*III · Where to play*

# GUANACASTE

**Costa Rica's main golf region: championship courses, luxury stays and a tropical beach backdrop.**

## TRES VOLCANES GOLF & COUNTRY CLUB

18 HOLES | PUBLIC PLAY

*Playas del Coco area*

A practical round for golfers staying around Playas del Coco, Playa Hermosa or Ocotal, and an easy add-on to a beach holiday. About 28 minutes from Liberia airport (LIR).

## HACIENDA PINILLA

18 HOLES · PAR 72 | TEE TIMES BOOKABLE

*Tamarindo / Santa Cruz*

One of the strongest choices for a full championship round. Stay at the JW Marriott (page 16), in Tamarindo or in a Hacienda Pinilla rental.

## RESERVA CONCHAL GOLF CLUB

18 HOLES | RESORT ACCESS ONLY

*Playa Conchal*

A Robert Trent Jones II design in a well-known resort setting, offered mainly to resort guests (Westin, page 12; W, page 18).

## OCEAN COURSE

18 HOLES · PAR 72 | RESORT / MEMBERS

*Papagayo Peninsula*

Arnold Palmer design with dramatic elevation changes and wide views over Bahía de Culebra. Access is restricted (Four Seasons, page 10).

## ZAPOTAL GOLF & BEACH CLUB

18 HOLES · PAR 72 | RESIDENTS & GUESTS

*Playa Zapotal*

A private residential club. Access is reported to be limited to residents and invited guests, so it isn't a dependable tee-time option.

## RANCHO LAS COLINAS GOLF & COUNTRY CLUB

18-HOLE CHAMPIONSHIP

PRIVATE · STATUS UNCLEAR

*Near Tamarindo*

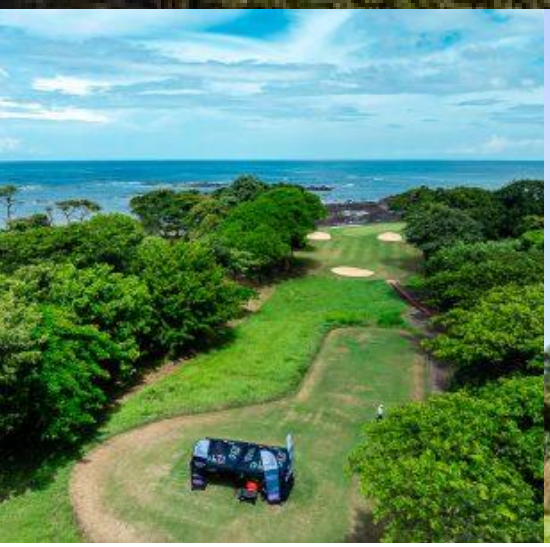
A Ron Garl design inside a gated community acquired by a developer. Confirm the current status before planning a round.





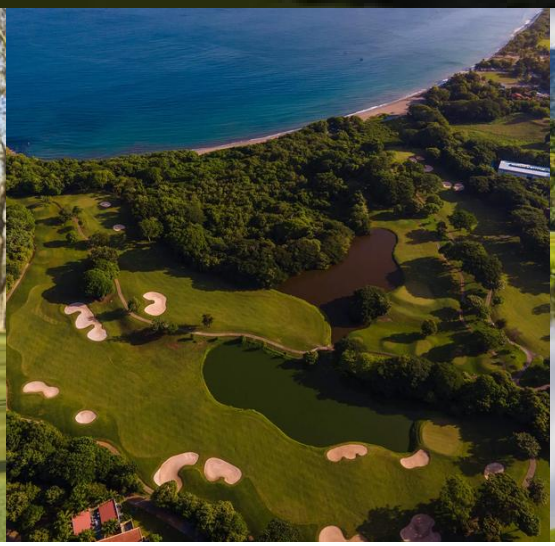


# TRES VOLCANES GOLF & COUNTRY CLUB





# HACIENDA PINILLA


# RESERVA CONCHAL GOLF CLUB





# OCEAN COURSE





# ZAPOTAL GOLF & BEACH CLUB





# RANCHO LAS COLINAS GOLF & COUNTRY CLUB



*III · Where to play*

# PUNTARENAS

**A province that runs from the Nicoya Peninsula to Osa, so the golf is just as varied. Most courses here are resort courses.**

## LA IGUANA GOLF COURSE

18 HOLES | PUBLIC TEE TIMES

*Playa Herradura, near Jacó*

Part of Los Sueños (page 14), but tee times are sold separately, so you can play without staying at the resort.

## LOS DELFINES GOLF & COUNTRY CLUB

9 HOLES | RESORT COURSE

*Tambor, Nicoya Peninsula*

A relaxed round to pair with a few beach days on the Nicoya Peninsula.

## TANGO MAR RESORT & GOLF

9 HOLES | RESORT COURSE

*Near Tambor, Nicoya*

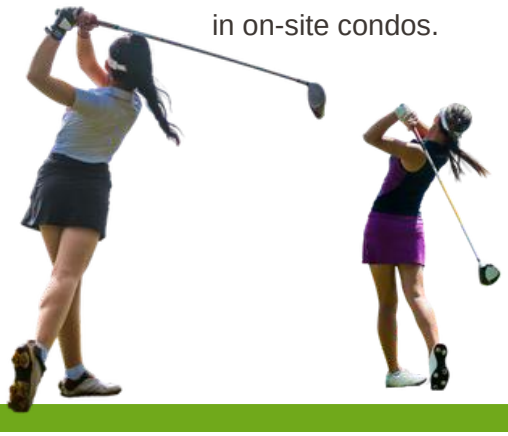
Beachfront rooms, villas, a spa and a short course on site: an easy golf-and-holiday package.

## OSA GOLF COURSE

9 HOLES | OPEN TO THE PUBLIC

*Osa*

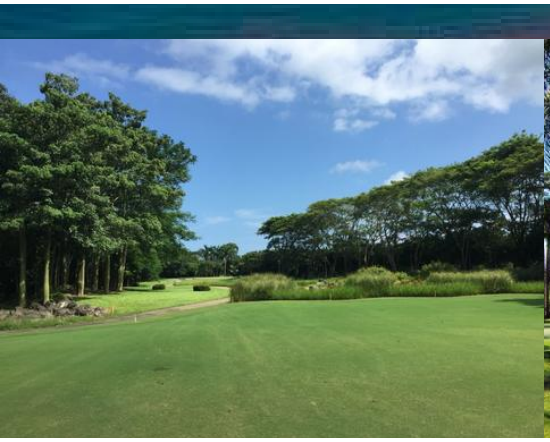
Wildlife, tropical scenery and a less-developed destination. Club rentals and stay-and-play packages in on-site condos.

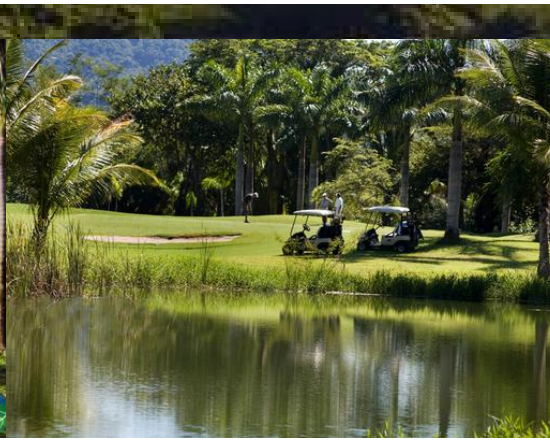






## LA IGUANA GOLF COURSE





## LOS DELFINES GOLF & COUNTRY CLUB



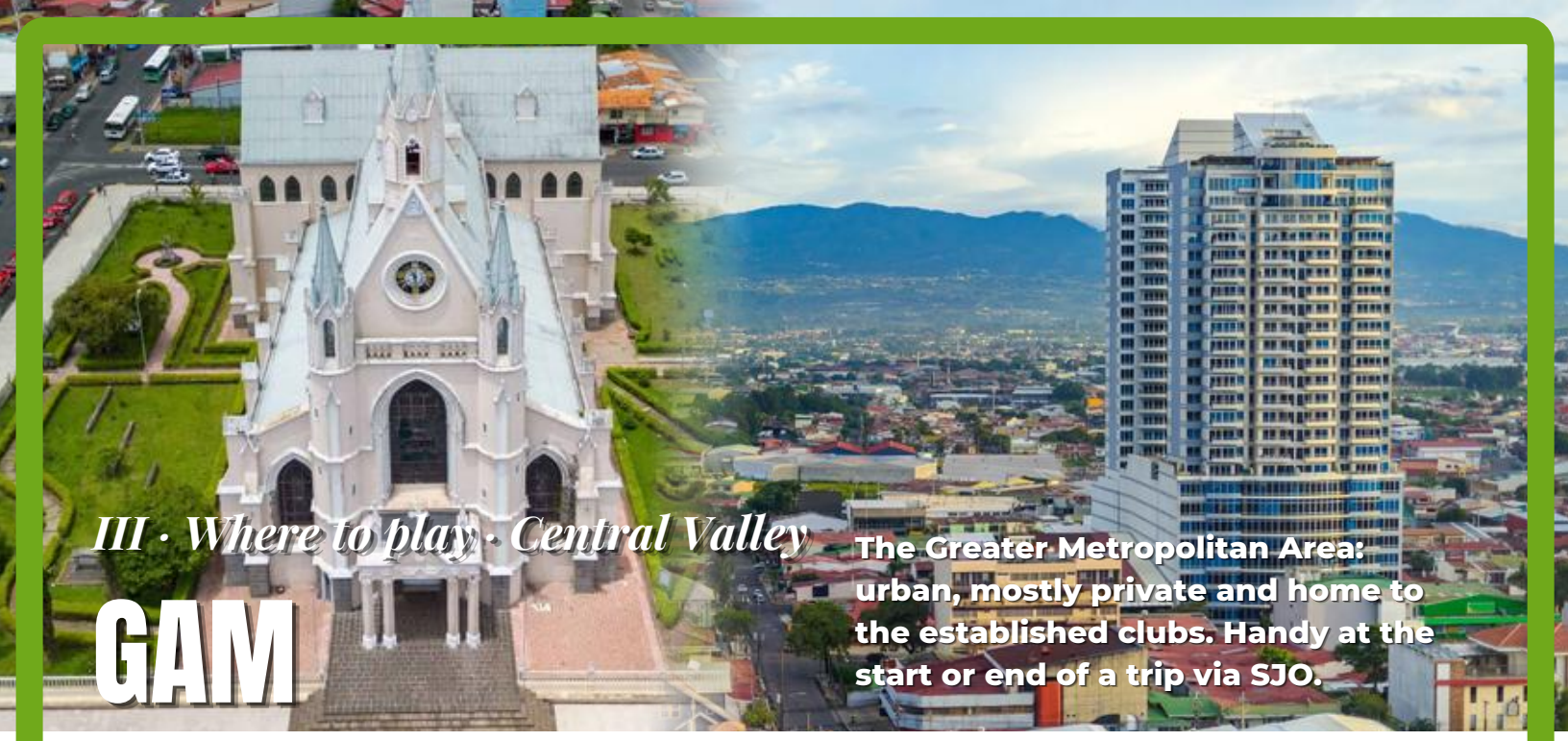


## TANGO MAR RESORT & GOLF





## OSA GOLF COURSE



*III · Where to play · Central Valley*

# GAM

**The Greater Metropolitan Area: urban, mostly private and home to the established clubs. Handy at the start or end of a trip via SJO.**

## VALLE DEL SOL GOLF COURSE

18 HOLES | PUBLIC

*Santa Ana, San José*

One of the most practical full courses for visitors, close to restaurants, business facilities and city excursions.

## COSTA RICA COUNTRY CLUB

9 HOLES | PRIVATE CLUB

*Escazú, San José*

A historic club dating back to 1940. Best for golfers with a local connection, reciprocal membership or a confirmed guest invitation.

## LOS REYES COUNTRY CLUB

9 HOLES | SEMI-PRIVATE

*La Guácima, Alajuela*

An established club in a residential setting, for a shorter round near the Central Valley. Confirm visitor access ahead.

## CARIARI COUNTRY CLUB

18 HOLES | PRIVATE CLUB

*Belén, Heredia*

A long-standing championship course near the airport. Arrange access in advance; Marriott Hacienda Belén (page 20) is close by.

## CAMPO DE GOLF MONTERÁN

18 HOLES · PAR 3 | CONFIRM ACCESS

*Curridabat, San José*

Good for short-game practice or a quick session in the Central Valley. The club says it is sanctioned by the World Handicap System.

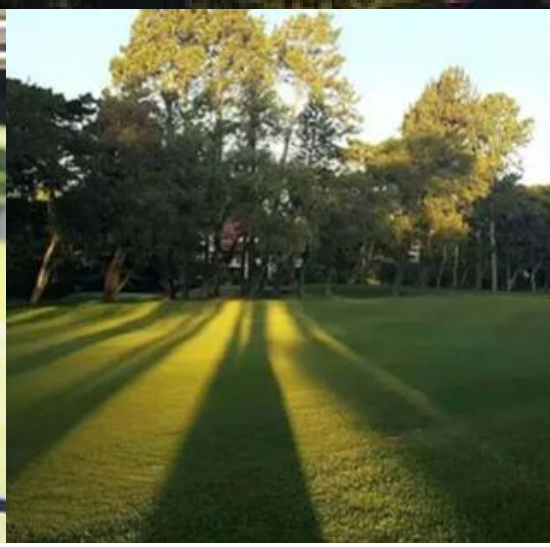






# VALLE DEL SOL GOLF COURSE





# CARIARI COUNTRY CLUB





# COSTA RICA COUNTRY CLUB





# CAMPO DE GOLF MONTERÁN






# LOS REYES COUNTRY CLUB

*IV · Attire and equipment*

# WHAT TO PACK

**Warm all year on the Pacific coast, cooler in the Central Valley and at altitude.**



## 01 *Clothing*

- Collared, moisture-wicking polo — practical and meets most dress codes.
- Lightweight, breathable shorts or trousers. Some clubs ban denim.
- Soft-spike or spikeless shoes. Some courses ban metal spikes.

## 02 *Sun and rain*

- High-SPF sunscreen, reapplied during the round.
- Broad-spectrum UV sunglasses and a hat or visor.
- Rain gear: rainfall varies a lot by region, and sudden storms happen.

## 03 *Equipment*

- Rental clubs are common, but check availability. Your own set is better.
- Plenty of balls and tees: water, vegetation and thick rough take their share.
- A glove for grip in the humidity, plus a bag rain cover and towels in the green season.

## 04 *Timing and bugs*

- Book morning tee times: cooler, and afternoon rain is more common in the green season, especially on the Pacific.
- Insect repellent for courses near woods or wetlands.





PAPAGAYO PENINSULA, GUANACASTE

# FOUR SEASONS RESORT, PENINSULA PAPAGAYO

## *Luxury golf on the northern Pacific*

One of the best options for clients with a high budget. Its signature 18-hole Ocean Course, designed by Arnold Palmer, offers extraordinary views of the Pacific Ocean.

Alongside the 18-hole course, there are courses and experiences for players of every skill level, with professional instruction, private lessons and tailored golf packages.

Beyond golf, guests can enjoy the resort's restaurants, pools and spa treatments, plus wildlife observation, kayaking and snorkelling.






# Practice, lessons and a certified course

In September 2026 the course received Certified Audubon Cooperative Sanctuary status, recognising its wildlife habitat management, water conservation and maintenance.

Practice facilities include a sand-bunker area, and putting and chipping greens. Certified PGA instructors for range lessons or guided 9- or 18-hole lessons on the course.

The pro shop stocks equipment, apparel and accessories, with club and ball rentals available on the course for minimum minutes away.

Some courses may be restricted to eligible members. Confirm availability before booking.

## Golf at a glance

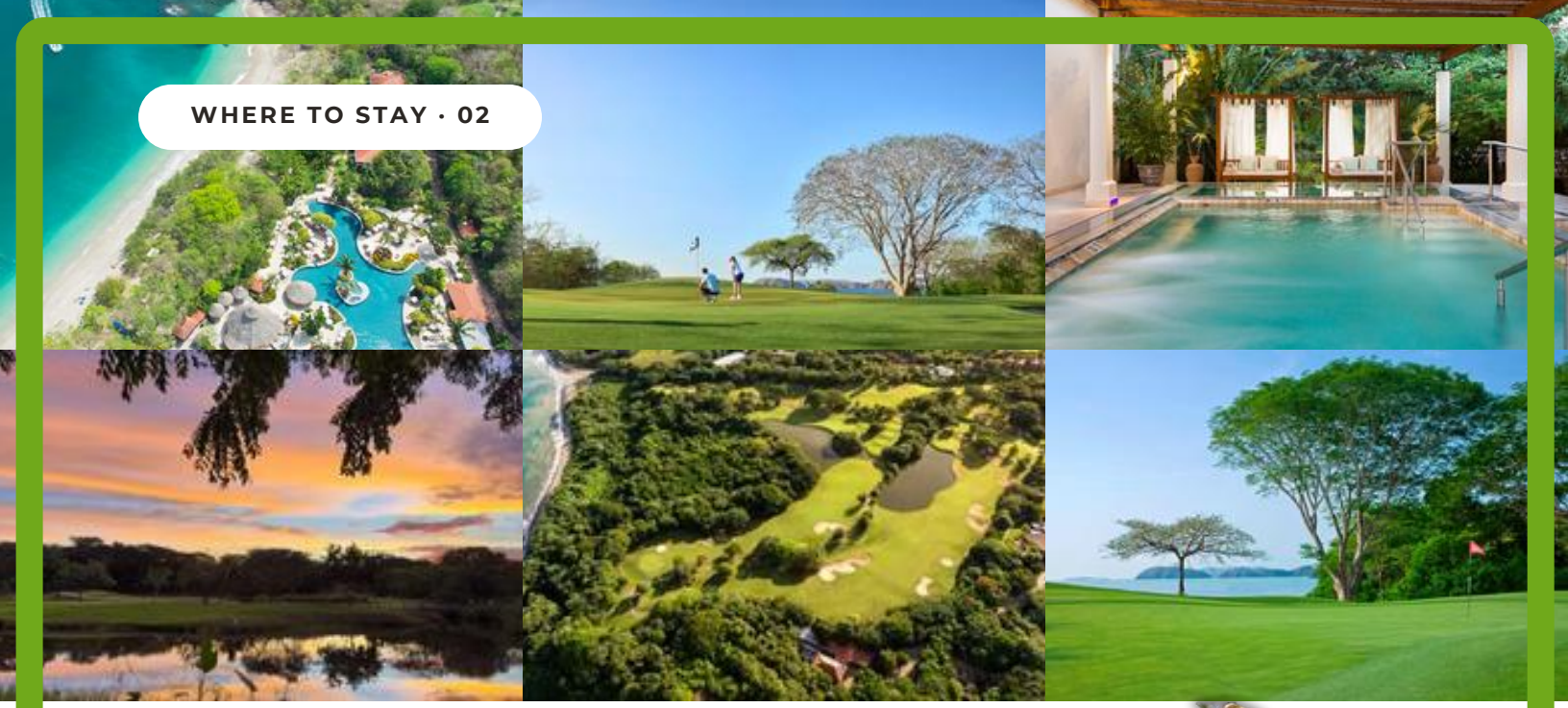
**COURSE**
Ocean Course · 18 holes, par 72

**DESIGN**
Arnold Palmer

**CERTIFICATION**
Audubon Cooperative Sanctuary, 2026

**LOBBY TO TEE**
7 minutes, free shuttle





CONCHAL BEACH, GUANACASTE

# Westin Reserva Conchal



## *All-inclusive with a championship course*

The Westin Reserva Conchal combines a tropical beach setting with an all-inclusive resort experience and access to an 18-hole course designed by Robert Trent Jones II.

The course features lush tropical vegetation, natural water features and varied terrain, creating a scenic, engaging round for golfers of different skill levels.

Off the course there are several restaurants and bars, pools, a spa, fitness facilities and access to beautiful Playa Conchal.









# Reserva Conchal Golf Course

An 18-hole, par-71 course set within a tropical landscape, with rolling fairways, natural vegetation and natural water features.

The layout works with the surrounding environment, offering gorgeous views and the chance to spot local wildlife while you play.

Facilities include a driving range, practice greens, a pro shop, lessons and equipment rentals, so there's no need to bring everything from home.

## Golf at a glance

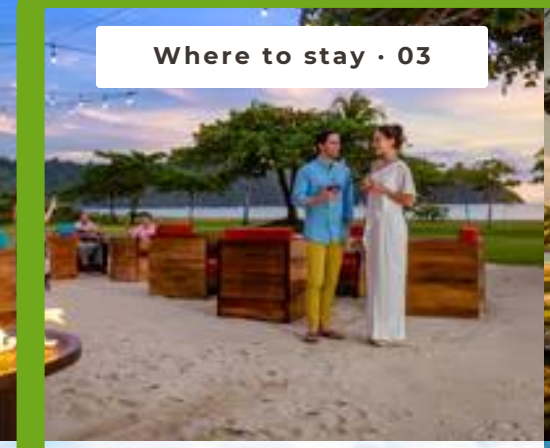
**COURSE**
18 holes · par 71

**DESIGN**
Robert Trent Jones II

**PLAN**
All-inclusive

**BEACH**
Playa Conchal



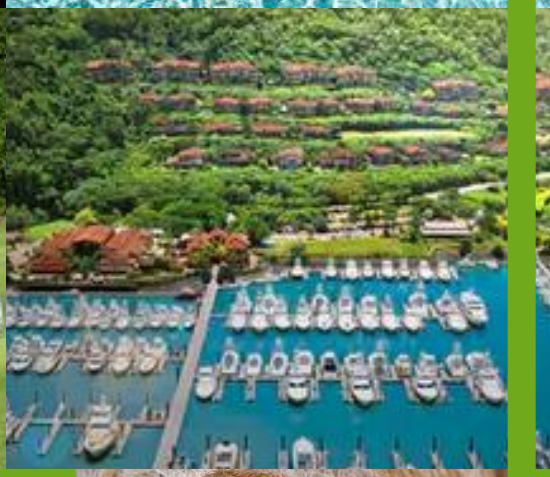












HERRADURA BEACH, CENTRAL PACIFIC

# Los Sueños Marriott Ocean & Golf Resort



## Golf between rainforest and marina

A beachfront resort near Playa Herradura, part of the Los Sueños Resort & Marina development.

Amenities include pools, fitness facilities, local and international dining, and a marina.

Golf is the main attraction: La Iguana Golf Club, an 18-hole, par-72 championship course with lush vegetation and local wildlife.











# *La Iguana Golf Club*

Its golf academy, led by PGA-certified professionals, covers putting, chipping, bunker play and course strategy, with specialised swing analysis.

The club hosts tournaments and corporate events, including the La Iguana Invitational (page 02). Multiple tee options match the challenge to each golfer's ability.

Golf, marina, tropical scenery and resort amenities make it ideal for golf enthusiasts, couples and travellers combining beach and nature.



## *World Golf Awards*

COURSE · 18 HOLES, PAR 72

**Designed by Ted Robinson**

COSTA RICA'S BEST GOLF COURSE

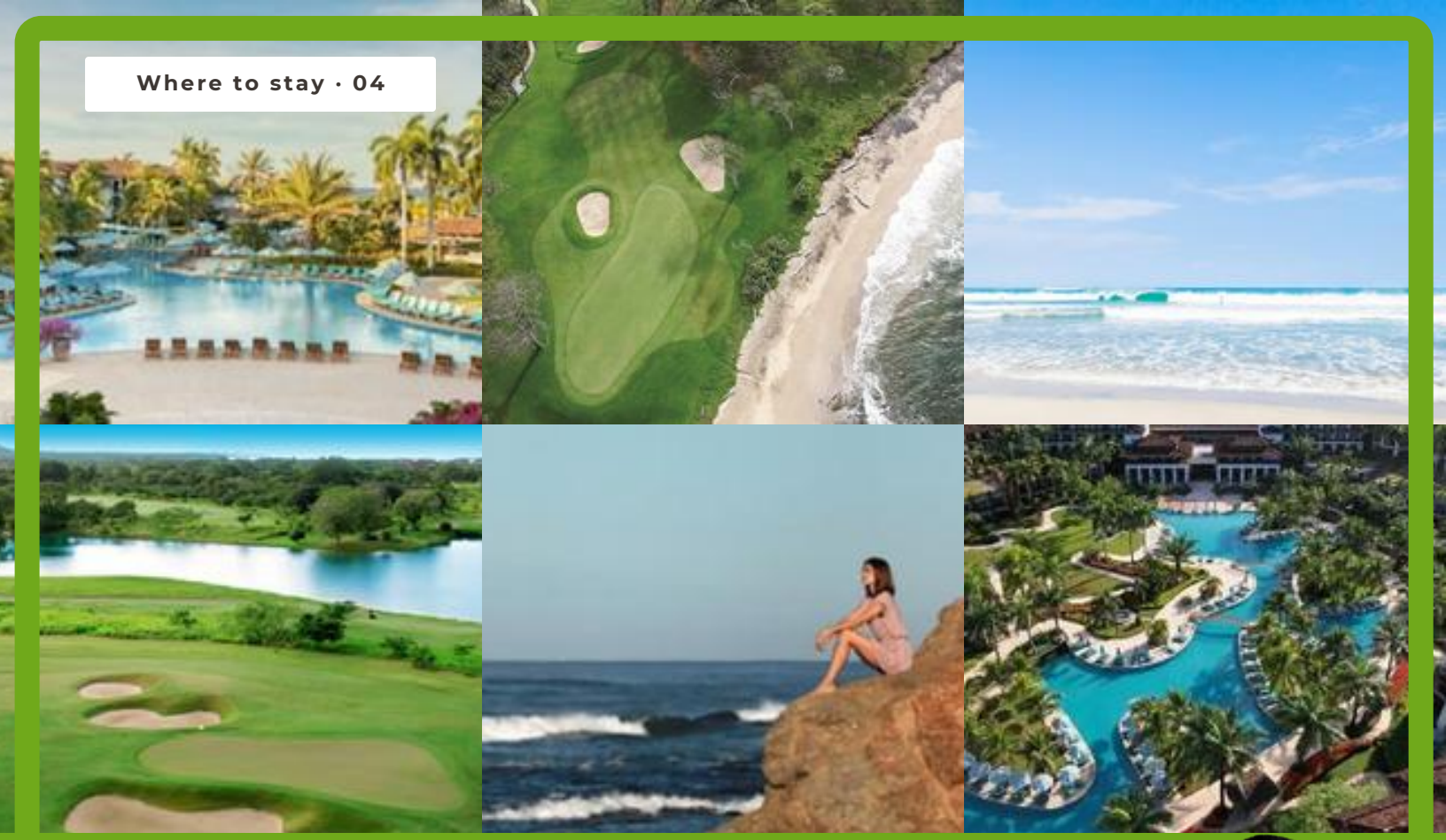
**2017 – 2020**

COSTA RICA'S BEST GOLF HOTEL

**2022 and 2023**

LATIN AMERICA'S BEST GOLF HOTEL

**2025**



HACIENDA PINILLA, NEAR TAMARINDO

# JW Marriott Guanacaste Beach Resort



## *A par 3 beside the sand*

On Playa Mansita within the Hacienda Pinilla community, this beach resort offers luxury on Costa Rica's Pacific coast, surrounded by tropical dry forest and gardens, with ocean views and a peaceful setting.

Spacious rooms, several restaurants and bars, a large infinity-style pool, a fitness centre and a spa with a wide range of treatments.

Guests have access to the nearby 18-hole Hacienda Pinilla course. The area also offers horseback riding, surfing, cycling and more.









# *Hacienda Pinilla Golf Course*

Designed by Mike Young, the course extends to about 7,200 yards. Wide playing areas meet strategically placed bunkers, and the ocean breeze adds an extra challenge, especially in the dry season.

The highlight is the par-3 15th, right beside the beach. There are multiple tees, instruction, rentals, a pro shop and a clubhouse with restaurant and bar.

It is certified as an Audubon Cooperative Sanctuary for its work protecting local wildlife and the surrounding ecosystem.



JW MARRIOTT · HACIENDA PINILLA

## *Golf at a glance*

**COURSE**

**18 holes · par 72 · ~7,200 yd**

**DESIGN**

**Mike Young**

**SIGNATURE HOLE**

**15th · par 3 on the beach**

**CERTIFICATION**

**Audubon Cooperative Sanctuary**



CONCHAL BEACH, GUANACASTE

# W COSTA RICA - RESERVA CONCHAL



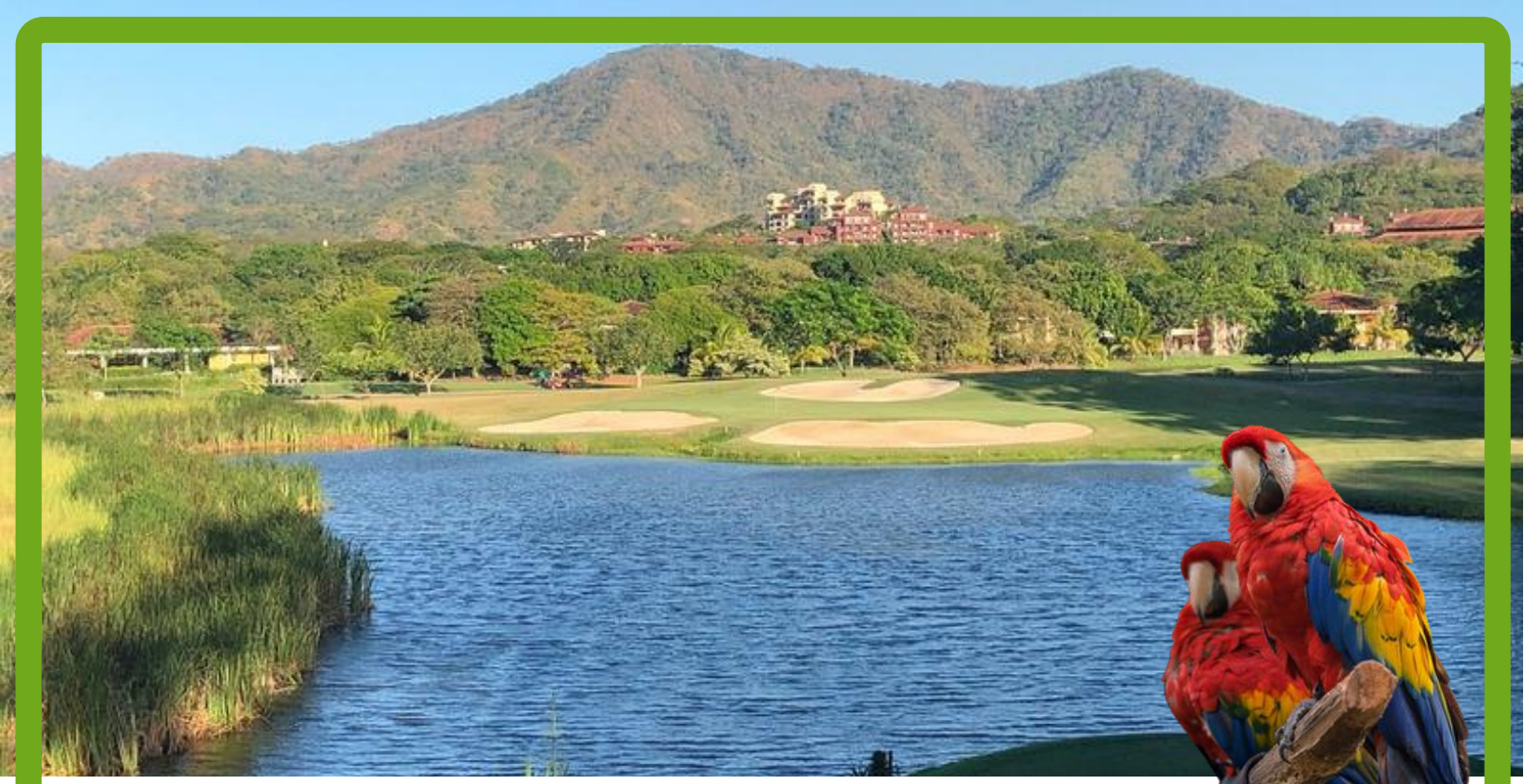


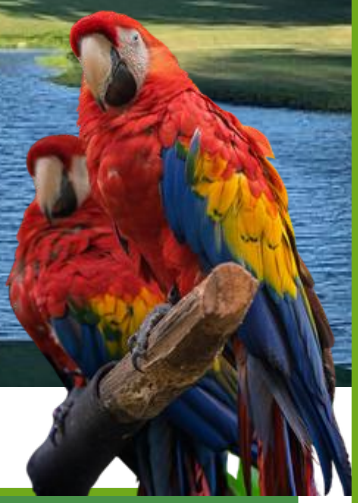
## *Contemporary luxury and golf*

Set within Reserva Conchal and surrounded by tropical vegetation, mangroves and coastline, the W pairs nature with contemporary luxury: bold architecture and sophisticated interiors.

About 150 rooms and suites, some with private plunge pools, balconies and landscape views, plus several restaurants and bars, pools, a fitness centre and a spa.

Playa Conchal, known for its clear water and a shoreline made partly of crushed seashells, is right on the doorstep.





# *After the round*

The resort provides access to the Reserva Conchal Golf Course (page 12) — an appealing option for combining golf with a stylish stay.

After the last hole: the spa, the pool, or the resort's restaurants and bars. Modern design, tropical surroundings and Playa Conchal make it ideal for couples and travellers seeking a sophisticated coastal getaway.

## *In brief*

**ROOMS**

**~150 rooms and suites**

**COURSE**

**Reserva Conchal Golf Course**

**COURSE DESIGN**

**Robert Trent Jones II**

**BEST FOR**

**Couples and stylish getaways**



LA RIBERA DE BELÉN, HEREDIA

# Costa Rica Marriott Hotel Hacienda Belén



## *The easy base for arrival or departure*



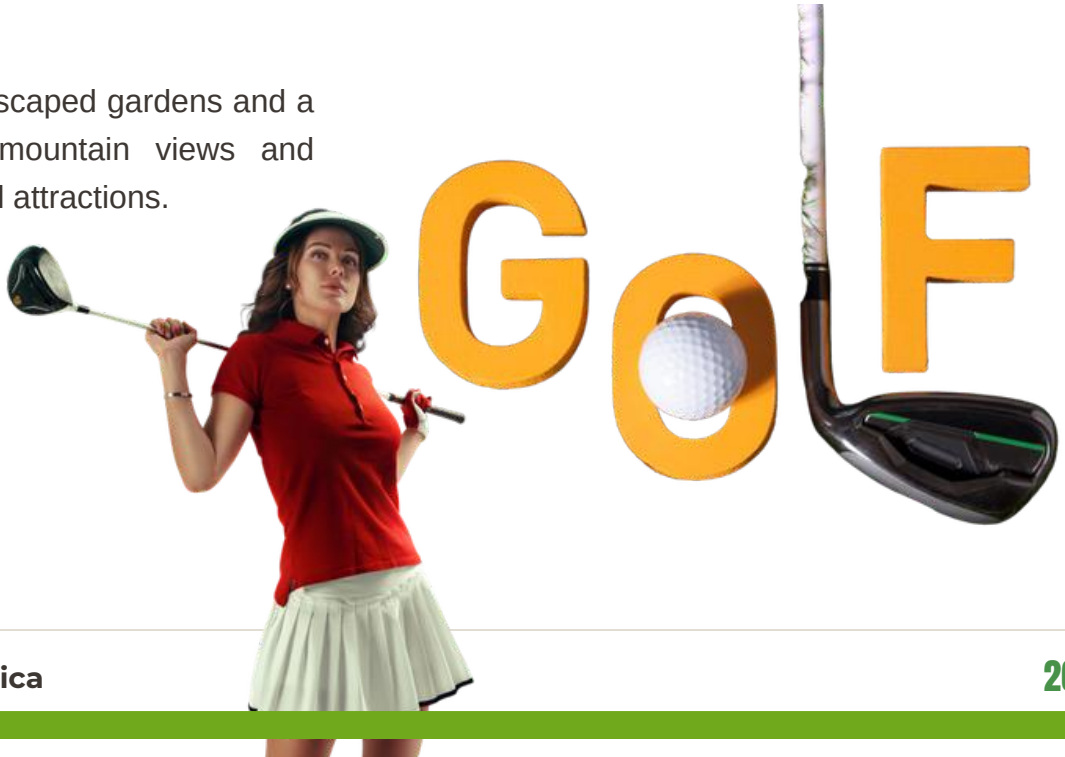





About 5 km from Juan Santamaría International Airport, this hotel combines modern facilities with the style of a traditional hacienda, reflecting Costa Rica's cultural and agricultural heritage.

The grounds include landscaped gardens and a coffee plantation, with mountain views and convenient access to local attractions.

Spacious rooms, several restaurants, outdoor pools, a fitness centre and the Kuö Spa, with treatments inspired by local ingredients.











# *Practise here, play Cariari*

Golf here focuses on practice: the on-site driving range includes areas for driving, pitching and sand shots.

There's no 18-hole course on the property, but Cariari Country Club (page 08) is nearby — a good base for a full round on a short stay at the start or end of a trip.

*Confirm access to nearby courses, tee times and equipment rentals for your dates.*



## *In brief*

**SJO AIRPORT**
About 5 km

**GOLF ON SITE**
Driving range · drive, pitch and sand

**NEARBY COURSE**
Cariari Country Club

**SPA**
Kuö Spa


Where golf meets paradise
TRAVEL XM
Pura Vida
PURA VIDA!
Green fees, hotels, transfers and everything between one round and the next. Tell us your dates and we'll build the trip.
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